Writing Cover Letters for Journal Submissions

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Cover Letters

Most journals require submission of a cover letter

- This is an opportunity to highlight aspects of your paper in a more casual way
- Explain why your paper is relevant to that journal
- Upon resubmissions communicate information not shared with reviewers

Format

- Find letterhead for your institution
- Address letter to that journal specifically and editor
  - Initial submission: look up editor(s)-in-chief
  - Resubmission: managining editor
- Have you title and signature for sign-off

One Recipe for Writing

The following is the meta structure I follow. It has worked well for me, but others might use different structures

- Paragraph 1:
  - Preamble. Introduce title of paper, state journal and article type, any author contribution statement as required by journal
- Paragraph 2:
  - Highlight gap(s) in prior research, how your paper addresses them
- Paragraph 3:
  - State why your paper is of interest to readership of that journal. Provide 3-5 specific points about why readers will care
  - Helpful to review aims of journal online

Paragraph 1

Example

- "We are pleased to submit our manuscript entitled '*[paper title]*' as a *[article type]* for exclusive consideration in *[Journal]*. All authors contributed to and approve of its submission *[or description of who contributed to what aspect]*"

Paragraph 2

Example

- "A fundamental challenge in *[topic area]* is to *[problem]*. Prior research has *[concise summary based on introduction]*. To address this challenge, we *[how you address the problem introduced]*.

Paragraph 3

Example:

- "Our work will be of intersted to the readership of *[Journal]*. First, our manuscript *[summarize how problem is addressed, why their readership cares about that problem]*. Next, we *[strength of your paper]*. Finally, we *[connection to aims of journal]*. Thank you for your consideration of our work."

Questions?